

PHRASE

A phrase is a group of words that does not contain a subject nor predicate. It does not have a finite verb and cannot make a complete sense. It only form part of a sentence. For instance the following group of words are phrases- the man, is my father, in the room. It only shows the relationship between ideas by giving detail about time place and pointing out the similarities.

CHARACTERISTICS OF PHRASE

- i. It has no subject and predicate.
- ii. It has no verb
- iii. It has no meaning on its own: It depend on other structure for it meaning
- iv. It make no complete sense.

TYPES OF PHRASES

Phrases might be identified in their functions relating to the grammatical elements. These means that we can have as many types of phrases as we have grammatical element. Phrases might thus function as:

- i. Noun phrase
- ii. Verb phrase
- iii. Adjectival phrase
- iv. Adverbial phrase
- v. Prepositional phrase.

NOUN PHRASE- does the work of a noun is called noun phrase e.g

- a. Early to bed- ~~early to bed~~ is a good habit
- b. To win the race- he has a strong desire to win the race.
- c. The audience- were getting bored.
- d. The man – danced.
- e. They- just danced.

VERB PHRASE: Contain a lexical or main verb without auxiliary it show the tense distinction e.g

- a. The man wept.
- b. They are travelling tomorrow.
- c. The man killed a snake.
- d. The man was happy.
- e. He has eaten the food.

ADJECTIVAL PHRASE: It does the work of an adjective is called adjective phrase e.g

- a. He was very afraid.
- b. The girl in a white dress is my sister.
- c. I love girls with long hair
- d. Helen is a very beautiful girl.

ADVERBIAL PHRASE: does the work of adverb is called adverb phrase e.g

- a. He was driving with a great speed,
- b. The accident took place on a spot.
- c. The man sat dejectedly.

PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE: does the work of preposition is called prepositional phrase e.g.
Of, no, in, by, from, inside, between etc.

- a. She was accused of stealing the book.
- b. She is in the garden.
- c. Halima turned to the first page of the book.
- d. That congratulated him on his success.

CLAUSES: A clause is a group of words that forms a sentence. A clause form a part of a sentence and contain subject and a predicate. Clause are classified according to their grammatical completeness. Clause must contain a finite verb. We have a complete and incomplete sentences, so we have main or principal clause and subordinate or dependent clauses.

MAIN CLAUSE: Those clause can stand on their own to make meaning, even when they are removed from other sentence they are refers to as main or principal clauses. e.g.
Mr. Paul is a good teacher.

I met my friend.
She was wound.

DEPENDENT CLAUSE: Is one that cannot stand on its own until when added to the main clause. Subordinate clause depends on the main clause for its full meaning. eg
When I was walking on the street-I met with my friend.

This is the boy-that stole the money.

I regretted my action-that I attended the wedding.

a. **NOUN CLAUSE :** Contain a subject and predicate it make meaning e.g.

i. I know that she is a teacher in the school.

ii. What I like most in her is her modesty?

b. **ADJECTIVE CLAUSE:** It contain a subject and a predicate and does the work of adjective. It usually introduce with word like who, which, that etc.

EXAMPLES:

i. This is the woman that killed the snake.

ii. I know the day which she travelled home.

iii. I want to know the time when the meeting will take place

NB- ADJECTIVAL OR RELATIVE: Tells more about a noun or pronoun and some compound words such as whosever, whatever etc.

ADVERBIAL CLAUSE: It modifies a verb, adverb or an adjective. There are various types of adverbial clauses: Time, place, manner, reason, purpose, condition, cause and frequency.

i. She sang as if she was sad.(manner)

ii. The accident occurred where three road meet. (Place)

iii. Do not talk while I am teaching. (Time)

iv. He came to Nigeria so that he might marry a Nigerian girl. (Purpose) etc.

NB: CHAACTERISTIC OF A CLAUSE:

➤ Have finite verbs.

➤ Can stand alone

➤ Make complete meaning.

*The clause may be combine with another clause to form a larger sentence.
SENTENCE

A sentence is a group of words that make a complete thought or sense. It is a basic unit of a written communication in a language. Is a string of words containing a noun phrase (subject) and a verb phrase (predicate): expressing a complete sense? Thus the basic function of a sentence is to communicate information.

TYPES OF SENTENCE

Sentence are classified and describe into two different ways;

i. By the meaning convey: statement, question, command and exclamation.

ii. By the structure: simple, complex, compound and compound –complex.

SENTENCE BY MEANING THE CONVEY:

- a. My brother bought a new car. (Statement)
- b. What is your names? (Wh-question)
- c. Sit down. (Command)
- d. what a pretty girl you are (exclamation)

SENTENCE BY STRUCTURES:

SIMPLE SENTENCE – Has one clause beginning with a noun group called subject one finite verb which may followed by a noun, adjective or adverb as a predicate e.g.

- a. Veronica sang a song.
- b. The girls scream.

THE COMPLEX SENTENCE: Contain one main clause with one or more subordinating clause joined together by subordinating conjunction. It is usually introduce with subordinating clause like because, if, that it may come before after or between the main clause examples:

- a. I am sure that you would make it if you try.
- b. She did not buy the car because she had no money.

COMPOUND SENTENCE: Has two sentence element (clause) that can be treated as equal. The clause are therefore linked together by coordinate conjunction such as and, but, or, for, and nor. This can be illustrated as follows:

- a. You may consider my advice or you may leave it.
- b. Amara cooked the food and her sister washed the plate.
- c. The book is big but the ruler is long.

NB-Compound sentence contain two or more clauses joined together by co-coordinating conjunction or semi colon example;

Veronica came late to the bank, but the banker allowed her to withdraw her money after the had considered her excuse as genuine,

COMPOUND COMPLEX SENTENCE, has two independent clauses and one or more dependent clause (s) examples;

- a. The woman came to see me, but I could not come out because I was busy inside the room.
- b. That he won the election has been confirmed by the electoral officer but how he got that number of vote is still not clear to many people.

SENTENCE PATTERNS: Types and characteristics.-the following patterns are among the common sentence in English.

i. PATTERN I. SUBJECT + VERB

- * Banker (S)+cheat (V)
- *Teacher (s) +teach (V)
- *Students (s) +cheat (V)
- *Dog (s) +eat (V)

NB-The verb are transitive, they therefore do not requires objects.

ii. PATTERN II SUBJECT + VERB + OBJECT

- *Mary(s) +sold (V) +her gold (o)=svo
- *Sheep(s) +cats –(V) grasses(o) = svo

iii. PATTERN III SUBJECT+VERB+ COMPLEMENT

- *My brother is a doctor =svc

*He has become a commissioner for health. (svc)

iv. PATTERN IV SUBJECT + VERB + INDIRECT OBJECT

- *They old man lived on charity.

V. PATTERN V SUBJECT + AUX + VERB + MAIN VERB + INDIRECT OBJECT

*The man was bitten by the snake.

*Ruth was praised by the H.O.D

VI. PATTERN VI SUBJECT + VERB + INTR + INDIRECT OBJ. + DIRECT OBJ.

* I gave her a flower

*My father wrote grace a letter.

vii. PATTERN VII SUBJECT + VERB + TRAN + DIRECT OBJ. + PHRASE

*The man gave hints on his friend.

viii. PATTERN VIII SUBJECT + VERB + TRA + PHR + DIRECT OBJ.

*The lecturer describe to the class all the narrative techniques.

DENOTATION AND CONNOTATION

MEANING- Is the idea which one intended to be communicated between persons. We can, say that word meaning is the dictionary meaning of words such dictionary meaning of words are also known as their denotative meanings. Denotation is a surface, literary or dictionary meaning of a word e.g. a monkey, sheep goat refer to the various animals. Similarly, a dove, vulture, cats, refer to the various birds. Denotation did not only refer to a word usage, we could have a phrase, clause or sentences to describe the idea of the speaker or writer.

- Audu married Aminna.

- The lecture is boring.

NB- In sentence one it means Audu married Aminna while in sentence two it state that the lecture is not interesting.

CONNOTATION: Means the deeper, implied or associative meaning of the word or sentence, certain words have their associative meaning base on the regional, tribe, culture even country. This means that we have to be careful in give connotative meanings of words. In Nigeria for instance; a sheep connote a foolish person that means he may follow any leader.

- A monkey connote a mischievous child.
- The cross connote suffering.
- A Vulture connote a person who is happy when other people are sad.
- Pig connotes a dirty person
- Parrot connote a talkative.
- A dove connote Holy Spirit.
- A tortoise refers to a cunning person.

Denotative meaning is the literal, surface or dictionary meaning while connotative meaning is the additional meaning the word gains because of the different environment in which the word has been used in the past. E.g. the denotative meaning of mother is female parent but its connotative meaning may arouse thoughts of cared, love sacrifice and protector. The connotative meaning of the words therefore make it deeper in meaning.

DENOTATIVE

*Red-color

*White- colour

* Black

*Bash holds the key to her heart

CONNOTATIVE

* Danger

*Peace

*Evil or sadness

*Bash has influence over her

- *Rose is a flower
- *Rock is a stone
- *Crown mean an adornment
- *chick means a 'baby bird'
- *politician has negative notion
- *He's such a dog
- * He stabbed me at the back
- *Love and beauty
- *person as solid and stable.
- *Royalty and power
- *derogatory term for a woman
- *wickedness and insincerity
- * shamelessness
- * He betrayed me
- Note.** Connotation meaning of word has similarly with idiom.
- DRAMA:** Is the only genre of literature that is associated with stage performance. Drama called play. A play is not yet a play unless it is acted on stage.

TYPES OF DRAMA

TRAGEDY: this is a serious play with a sad ending. An example is Shakespeare's Romeo and Juliet.

COMEDY: This type of play aims at provoking smiles and laughter. It is a lighter form of drama which end in a happy mode.

TRAGIC-COMEDY: The action is serious in theme and subject matter and sometimes in tone as well. It also seems to be leading to a tragic catastrophe until an unexpected turn in event, bringing about a happy resolution.

FARCE: this is the type of drama that provoking excessive laughter based on unlikely situations.

BURLESQUE: this is a form of comedy characterized by ridiculous exaggeration. The quality which makes a burlesque is the discrepancy between subject matter and style.

FEATURES OF DRAMA

- **STAGE:** All plays are acted on a stage. A stage can be any raised portion above the seats of the audience in the theater.
- **PLAYWRIGHT:** This refers to the writer of a play.
- **AUDIENCE:** The people watching the play as it being acted on the stage.
- **MIME:** This is the type of play that is based purely on gesture without speech.
- **COSTUME:** This refers to the materials used by actors and actresses in a play.
- **ANTAGONIST:** this is the one that opposes the main character in a play.
- **PROTAGONIST:** Hero refers to the male central character in a play while heroine is the female counterpart.
- **CONFLICT:** this is the struggle or disagreement that the protagonist or antagonist faces.
- **FLEW:** this is the main thing that leads to the fall of a hero.